Chapter 5
Nation Branding, in What Context?
Spatial Competitiveness and Attractiveness

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ABSTRACT

This chapter examines the conceptual evolution of national identity and specificity creation and promotion (nation branding), combining it with theoretical background and developments in the concept of competitiveness and attractiveness and suggesting a new interpretive framework for understanding nation branding policy and strategy. The chapter is divided into specific elliptical steps, with the first one concerning the critical overview of nation branding recent literature, developed towards understanding the main research directions related to competitiveness. Competitiveness and attractiveness are then presented as a dynamic and undivided diptych, which cannot be exhausted in fragmented nation-centric approaches but arises through dynamic processes at the co-evolving levels of spaces, industries, and firms. In conclusion, a systemic contour for understanding space is composed and suggested as a multi-layered continuum, called the "cone of entrepreneurial and innovational dynamics," which can be the substantial basis for articulating an integrated nation branding policy.

INTRODUCTION

The study of the development of national identity gradually becomes a field of diffusion of marketing concepts and practices in national economic policies, mainly from a socio-cultural perspective, capable of leading to subtle changes in all correlations concerned and functioning most often as a tool of soft

DOI: 10.4018/978-1-7998-7533-8.ch005

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power and promotion of national image and interests (Melissen, 2005; Nye, 1990; Pistikou, 2018). These slender adaptations occur because the receivers of these messages of the ensued nation-promotion strategy take as added value the specific culture of the nation they "buy into." It should be noted that brand-building processes require long-lasting adherence since, in the short run, only a little payoff may materialize (Masouras, Komodromos, & Papademetriou, 2019; O'Shaughnessy & Jackson, 2000; Siakalli & Masouras, 2020; Sophocleous, Masouras, & Papademetriou, 2019). To this end, nations need to incorporate an integrated strategic perspective when formulating the nation-brand instead of targeting and supporting ephemeral and meteoric advertising campaigns (Morgan, Pride, & Pritchard, 2002).

Moreover, any typical overview of the terminology followed by theorists and advocates of nation branding, a concept which has prevailed for the development of such nationwide marketing strategies of a country's identity, reveals a relative inadequacy in examining the dimensions relating to the competitiveness of industries and firms other than nations, as well as the corresponding co-produced and co-evolving dynamics of attractiveness. As examined in the subsequent literature review section, that nation branding marketers seem to often treat the national socio-economic system as a "canned" product, excluded from globalization's dynamics. However, from an overarching perspective and via available data, it becomes clear that the current phase of globalization does not lead to the definitive homogenization of the different societies of the planet that is eliminating all their socio-cultural specificities (Acemoglu & Robinson, 2012; Vlados, Deniozos, & Chatzinikolaou, 2018). Globalization does not come to impose a complete cultural and ideological homogenization of all societies and, in this way, the "end of history" (Fukuyama, 1992). On the contrary, it reproduces heterogeneity incessantly, which leads to increased differentiation and allows various local idiosyncrasies to coexist and co-evolve (linguistic, cultural, merit-based, symbolic). Therefore, contemporary global dynamics seem to make up the actual context for integrating the nation branding concept.

With this as a given, this research focuses on the following three theoretical considerations, which reflect the upcoming three sub-sections of the study. Overall, the purpose of this chapter is to distinguish the conceptual evolution of nation branding, to combine it with the study of competitiveness and attractiveness and to arrive at a new theoretical framework for the conception of national economic policy and strategy through an introductory overview of the relevant literature. The questions that will be addressed are the following:

1. What is the recent evolution of nation branding's concept, in what theories it is based on, and why does it matter?
2. If it is significant to understand how nations "self-advertise," then why do the dimensions and scientific documentation of competitiveness (especially an approach that does not just focus on the nation's perspective and side) seem to remain quite under-exploited?
3. If attractiveness is the other side of the same coin of any space's or actor's socio-economic development with competitiveness, what could be a new theoretical framework within which modern nation branding can function to articulate such a strategy?

NATION BRANDING: A LONG HISTORY OF SUBCUTANEOUS STIMULATION OF NATIONAL COMPETITIVENESS?

The concept of a successful "brand" began to take shape mainly in the 1990s, attempting to systematize the idea that the name, symbols, design and other "visual" dimensions that lead the prospective buyers to recognize a product is a process that drives the creation of a sustainable differential advantage for the entire organization (Baker, 1992). In addition to the producer's perspective, the concept of a successful brand also concerns that of the consumer since an organization's symbolic identity combines a set of characteristics and leads to added value in practical, theoretical, and even emotional terms (Lynch & De Chernatony, 2004). In this methodological orientation, the brand is mainly an output that creates a mental vision for current and future recipients of the service and, therefore, marketers should focus on the dimensions that cause this commitment to those who buy into the product (De Chernatony & McDonald, 2003).

In creating a strong brand with vigorous extensions at a cultural and added-value level, nation branding approaches also have appeared, which concern pre-existing stereotypes at the national level imprinted on consumers' beliefs, being therefore institutionally perplexed and present for long historical periods. Significant marketing theorists have analyzed this creation of relatively immutable cultural stereotypes nationwide (Kotler & Keller, 2006; Temporal, 2002). In line with the brand leadership approach, it makes sense that if nations operate within this framework, they need to develop long-term strategies to improve the image and stereotypes that are capable of "selling" mainly to external customers as a lever to raise investment and thus improve their attractiveness (Aaker & Joachimsthaler, 2000).

The foundations of the nation branding field are located mostly in the "Marketing places: Attracting investment, industry, and tourism to cities, states and nations" by Kotler et al. (1993), and in subsequent special issues of scientific journals dedicated to this "sophisticated" scope of national marketing strategy (Lodge, 2002; Papadopoulos & Heslop, 2002). Anholt's research (1998, 2007) is also pivotal, leading to a relevant index of how good a nation is (today there are also other corresponding indexes such as the following two that focus on nation branding aspects related to trade and tourism: Bloom Consulting, 2020a, 2020b). According to Olins (2002), the national symbols, names, and other dimensions that make a nation stand out in competition, go quite deep into history, so nation branding is just a modern way of expressing pre-existing trends. A thorough definition that appears from the study of the historical evolution of the concept made by Dinnie (2008, p. 15) is as follows: the nation-brand is "*the unique, multi-dimensional blend of elements that provide the nation with culturally grounded differentiation and relevance for all of its target audiences*."

Two other related concepts that need to be mentioned before analyzing the context in which nation branding theory moves today are public diplomacy and the country-of-origin effect. According to Kerr and Wiseman (2018), nation branding is a form of public diplomacy used to harness significant conceptual content from the science of marketing within states, motivated to enhance national reputation in international relations. At the same time, nation branding also concerns the successful production and export of products and services using the nation's differentiation and diversification, something mentioned in the literature as a country-of-origin effect (Dinnie, 2004; Johnson et al., 2016).

Therefore, nation branding is simultaneously a way to reinforce a state's soft power (Potter, 2008), a geopolitics tool, and an economic and managerial method for improving attractiveness and competitiveness. It revolves around the national context by promoting a specific national "image" and determining whether a country is comparatively more potent in terms of culture, governance, people, exports, tour-

ism, investment, immigration, and other similar directions (Anholt, 2005). Table 1 presents an engaging variety of recent contributions, trying to understand the way scholars approach nation branding as a theoretical notion. For this reason, the first column distinguishes significant definitions, the second introduces elements from relevant research that enrich the related scientific debate, and the third column draws conclusions.

Therefore, nation branding's theory and practice are geared towards strengthening a nation's reputation—seemingly, various nation branding scholars borrow elements from corporate reputation concepts (see, for example, Andrikopoulos & Koronis, 2007). However, most of the time, they do not answer what nation branding implementations structurally stimulate, tending to leave out from the conceptual content and scope the firms' actions within the nation and the co-structured industries and not explicitly referring to both competitiveness and attractiveness enhancement. In this analytical context of the synthetic form of competitiveness and attractiveness, a theoretical misconception and fragmentation of parameters and variables also appear in theorizing competitiveness. In other words, it is common nowadays to treat competitiveness as a macro-target, focusing on the need to stimulate the nation's potential primarily and, secondly, on the competitiveness dimension of different firms and industries.

In this context, although there was an awareness that one could come across approaches that stress the need to strengthen only the nation, we tried to emphasize recent publications that have mostly a conceptual content (Table 1) and deconstruct their main characteristics and where these contribute to the theory. The publications were sorted by employing a semi-systematic and critical evaluation of the literature (Snyder, 2019), while particular attention was paid to the ones related to the need to reinforce competitiveness. Overall, more than 500 articles on nation branding are listed in Scopus in January 2021, with some 400 published after 2010 (set as a general keyword the term "nation branding"). According to the articles (and their focal points) extracted and presented in Table 1, this nation branding study is limited mostly to the factors that start from the literature of marketing, cultural studies, and, at best, within geopolitics' theoretical background. These articles presented seem to not comprehensively examine the field of evolutionary theorizing since they do not study as extensively the micro, meso and macro levels of socio-economic structuration. It cannot be argued that the study of phenomena related to national identity marketing is of no value; it merely does not include the evolutionary dynamics of the levels included in today's multilevel rationale of reinforcing competitiveness and attractiveness. Nation branding corresponds to a subcutaneous—under the first layer of the skin of the factors acknowledged by most nation branding theorists, critics, or advocates—stimulation of national competitiveness and attractiveness that cannot integrate (or at best identify) the multiple levels of space. This problem is present even though nation branding indirectly concerns the area called "competitiveness/attractiveness diptych," a concept used in the past that is also about to be analyzed in the subsequent sections to clarify where a nation branding strategy must focus.

COMPETITIVENESS AND ATTRACTIVENESS AS SYSTEMIC DIPTYCH: A MULTILEVEL CRITICAL EVALUATION BEYOND EXCLUSIVELY FOCUSED NATION-CENTRIC PERSPECTIVES

From an evolutionary perspective to the global economy, and beyond a nation-centric framework, space, economic sectors (or industries) and all the actors involved in the process are interdependent, forming a dynamic whole. At the root of this interdependence, the multilevel or systemic competitiveness within

Table 1. Definitions, contributions, and conclusions from the nation branding scientific literature. Selected articles from 2010 to early 2021

Author	Significant nation branding definition provided	Significant points discussed in nation branding analysis	Conclusion about nation branding
Branding the nation: Towards a better understanding (Fan, 2010)	Nation branding involves creating or altering, monitoring, evaluating, and proactively managing a nation's images; the goal is to enhance its reputation in a targeted foreign audience.	The author develops a conceptual framework to explain the origins and the various meanings of the term, drawing detailed comparisons between nation branding and commercial branding.	Nation branding is not a myth but a way for a nation to achieve a better image by communicating its success to a foreign audience.
Democracy and nation brand(ing): Friends or foes (Kemming & Humborg, 2010)	The idea of the "brand state" reflects various readings from the symbolic entity to branding's organizational principles in governmental action.	Is democracy good or bad for a nation-brand?	In terms of their esteem of other world citizens, thoroughly democratic nations consistently show high scores. This outcome means that no non-democratic procedures are necessary for successful brand management.
The politics of nation branding: Collective identity and public sphere in the neoliberal state (Varga, 2013)	Nation branding refers to an inner-oriented cultural-political measure directed at the national state's people.	Nation branding involves politics that entail constructing symbolic markets, decoupling the nationalist vocabulary from history and cultural context, undermining traditional forms of solidarity and the undemocratic redistribution of definitional authority and public funds.	Nation branding impedes democratic or at least transparent public processes through which it is possible to negotiate collective representations. This outcome is contradictory to the common belief that nation branding is a "public good."
Nation branding: A tool for nationalism? (Jordan, 2014)	Nation branding works in the same manner as traditional public relations; it is a practice undertaken to persuade the public, investors, partners, employees, and other stakeholders to adopt a specific perspective about the nation-state.	Is nation branding a more palatable version of nationalism?	Nation branding may be a vehicle for soft nationalism (but still nationalism), and thus not as innocent as it may sound at first.
Relocation branding: A strategic framework for attracting talent from abroad (Silvanto & Ryan, 2014)	The notion that nations compete for resources such as tourists, skilled migrants, investment, and trade constitutes the basis of nation branding.	This research aims to propose a strategic framework and terminology for nation branding to attract highly skilled workers.	The authors suggest using the term "relocation branding" to describe the practice of using branding strategies to attract talent.
Nation branding, national self-esteem, and the constitution of subjectivity in late modernity (Browning, 2015)	Nation branding tries to evoke emotional ties to a specific nation and what that nation might stand for.	Nation-branding processes always respond to states and state leaders' need to reinforce the sense of ontological security and (self)-esteem of both their citizens and the nation.	If the theories and claims of branding "experts/consultants" spread even further, this may also intensify the sense of disenfranchisement and elitism people experience in various modern policies.
The 4D Model of the country image: An integrative approach from the perspective of communication management (Buhmann & Ingenhoff, 2015)	The nation branding construct refers to both the branding strategy and the consumer's beliefs towards the respective nation.	This conceptual article introduces an integrative country image model based on business studies, social psychology, political science, and communication science.	The country image corresponds to a subjective stakeholder attitude towards a nation and its state, including personal views and general feelings in a functional, normative, esthetic, and sympathetic dimension.
Nation branding and development: Poverty panacea or business as usual? (Browning, 2016)	Nation branding has gained increased currency with multiple countries employing branding consultants, setting up branding commissions and producing branding strategies to enhance their profile and image.	Nation-branding advocates claim that, with globalization converting the world into a single global marketplace, everyone competes for market share with everyone else.	This article argues that nation branding has arisen as increasingly self-reinforcing rhetoric that further normalizes and promotes the so-called "market fundamentalism," based on the inevitabilities of globalization and "neoliberal economics."
The role of cultural diplomacy in nation branding (Hurn, 2016)	Nation branding means designing, planning, and communicating a country's name and identity that builds or manages its reputation and enhances its international profile.	Cultural diplomacy signifies a form of "soft power" (the third pillar of foreign policy) and political and economic diplomacy, having a powerful nation branding manifestation.	Nation branding can function as a blatant propaganda instrument, and, therefore, the significance of cultural diplomacy (nation branding) must be incorporated into a country's training and development.
Having a soul or choosing a face? Nation branding, identity and cosmopolitan imagination (Ståhlberg & Bolin, 2016)	Nation branding is a consumer cosmopolitanism that celebrates cultural diversity within nations and worldwide. Judging by the branding campaigns, the impression is not a deep concern with large political problems.	If national branding includes constructing and promoting national identity, what kind of "identity" might this be?	Nation branding is a practice motivated and pursued by concerns of the market, not by democratic policy. If nation-states still depend on a certain sense of collective solidarity, nation branding does not supply the respective tools for addressing these political concerns.
Nation branding for foreign direct investment: An integrative review and directions for research and strategy (Papadopoulos et al., 2016)	Nation branding aims to foster a positive reputation for the country and its people, set up its brand identity, enhance its products' export, and attract tourists and foreign direct investment.	This paper compares the well-established literature on decision-making and location choice in FDI with studies in the nascent field of nation branding.	This study highlighted possibilities for scholars interested in FDI, nation branding (place marketing), or both.
Nation branding as an emerging field – An institutionalist perspective (Merkelsen & Rasmussen, 2016)	Nation branding is both a theoretical possibility (increasing number of academic papers after the term coined in the mid- 1990s) and a practical necessity (all nations have a brand that needs management in global competition).	It seems that the brand concept is almost void of meaning; however, this feature tends to become an indispensable requisite for setting up nation branding as a field for practical implications and academia.	Despite the ongoing academic productivity, nation branding needs further clarifying and systematizing to reach a normal science-like situation.
The placement of country reputation towards place management (Mariutti, 2017)	Nation branding has arisen as an extension to "place branding" to describe a place's identity, image, and reputation. Researchers associate the concept with political, economic, and diplomatic applications.	This paper traces nation-branding development as a place management recommendation from country reputation studies to align country reputation with place management.	Nine papers have discussed the country's reputation topic since 2005, although none dealt with place management principles. In this context, such theoretical and managerial advancements could help countries achieve sustainable prosperity.
Relationship building in nation branding: The central role of nation brand commitment (Wu, 2017)	A nation-brand is a high-level description of a particular country, including geographic locations, residents, cultures, economic situations, or politics.	Nation branding refers to in-depth relationship building.	Commitment, trustworthiness, cultural values, and cultural distance can form a conceptual model explaining how nation branding influences consumers' traveling and product purchase intentions.

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Table 1. Continued

Author	Significant nation branding definition provided	Significant points discussed in nation branding analysis	Conclusion about nation branding
Introduction: Nation branding and competitive identity in world politics (Browning & Oliveira, 2017)	Even though consultants and practitioners strive to distance nation branding from more pejorative labels such as propaganda, an in-depth historical analysis could show that nation branding might not be as distinct as widely asserted.	Modern nation branding programs infuse significant geopolitical narratives and scripts.	Nation branding exists within a world where states try to discipline narratives to secure sectional advantages. Thus, nation branding does not transcend geopolitics but constitutes a (new) strategic instrument for the politics of geographical imaginations.
The less transparent, the more attractive? A critical perspective on transparency and place branding (Mabillard & Vuignier, 2017)	Place branding scholars are interested in attractiveness factors, studying aspects such as investment promotion, company location, and foreign direct investment.	Is a more transparent place more attractive?	While the regulatory framework's transparency can effectively improve a place's attractiveness, the opacity of legal requirements may also attract foreign investors.
Two decades of research on nation branding: A review and future research agenda (Hao et al., 2019)	Nation branding refers to using branding and marketing communications techniques to promote a nation's reputation.	This paper conducts a systematic literature review to synthesize nation branding research.	There is terminological confusion in the literature. Nation brand, nation branding, country brand, country reputation and country image are not interchangeable.
Dissemination and consensual perceptions of nation brands: A framework for future research (Torelli, 2019)	The nation-brand refers to national identity (what the country means for its nationals) or national image (how others perceive the country).	This research suggests a framework for communicating a country's image and understanding nation-brands' nature and resilience.	The factors that affect a nation brand's consensual image can include the country's political and economic power, the widespread adoption of the nation's language and the nation's cultural attractiveness, as expressed in the distribution of movies, music, and other mass-reaching cultural products.
Nation branding: A useful category for international history (Gienow-Hecht, 2019)	Nation branding means improving international credibility, attracting global capital, increasing international political influence, tourism, and investment, enhancing nation-building, keeping talent, and reversing negative conceptions that might occur alongside international rating downgrades.	This study shows that nation branding is a useful theoretical instrument for studying international relations and international history.	Studying nation branding in a historical context can help understand the long-term trajectories of statehood, self-representation, and domestic and international identity management.
Interrogating place brand – a case of two cities (Ojo, 2020)	Nation branding means applying branding and marketing communications methods to reshape a country's international audiences' beliefs.	Country branding, city branding, and region branding are interconnected concepts.	Cities can create influential brands irrespective of the reputation (strong or weak) of their countries of origin. This reverse relationship between the nation-brand and city-brand can also expand the city-brand and place-brand theoretical framework. Also, it is not easy to conceptually separate national identity from place-brand.
Nation branding as a market-shaping strategy: A study on South Korean products in Vietnam (Nguyen & Özçaglar-Toulouse, 2021)	The "nation branding" and "state and market" literature are complementary since the nation branding concept treats external forces as market actors directly or indirectly involved in shaping the domestic market.	This paper examines how the state employs nation branding as a market-shaping strategy, arguing that alternative neoclassical market perspectives neglect the state's degree of embeddedness into markets.	Beyond conventional and simplistic neoclassical assumptions that dominate the marketing field, the state is a powerful institutional actor and, therefore, building a nation-brand can reinforce the nation's attractiveness and competitiveness.
Nation branding in the COVID-19 era: South Korea's pandemic public diplomacy (Lee & Kim, in press)	Nation branding concerns a country's global image, covering political, economic, and cultural dimensions, a context that also is valid for managing the COVID-19 pandemic.	This study addresses the interplay between public diplomacy in the COVID-19 era ("pandemic diplomacy, COVID-19 diplomacy, or coronavirus diplomacy") and nation branding.	A "pandemic public diplomacy" framework refers to state-initiated efforts to communicate material and immaterial resources with foreign publics to mitigate the health threat, foster a positive nation-brand, and contribute to a healthful global environment.

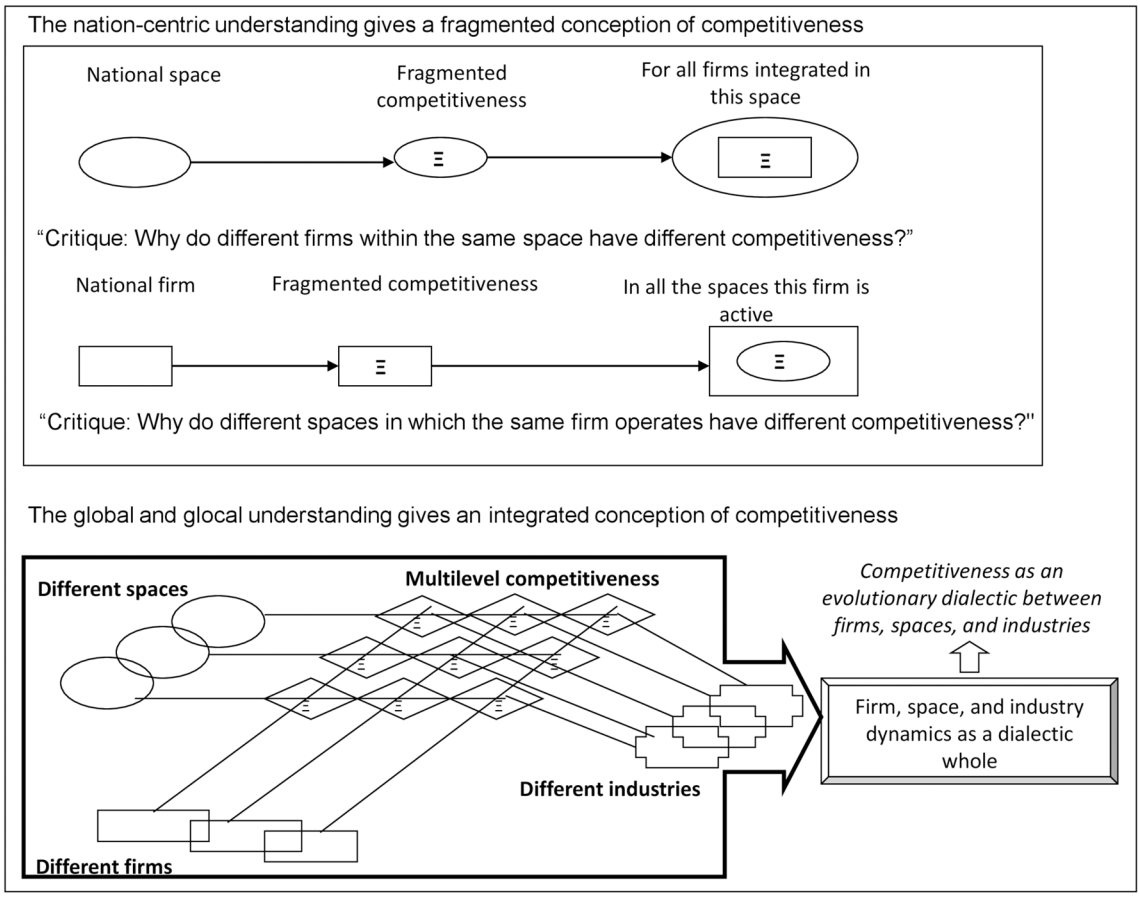
the global process is created (Esser et al., 2013; Peneder, 2017; Vlados & Chatzinikolaou, 2020). Even though competitiveness refers to an organization's ability to perform better in broadly conceived innovational terms than other related organizations, the underlying nation-centric perspective most often dominates the relevant research directions, thereby dichotomizing and sterilizing the competitiveness notion in analytical terms. The concept of competitiveness as a product and characteristic of space or as a firm's dynamic dimension is an increasingly used ineffective distinction, starting from traditional neoclassical or neo-Keynesian macroeconomic or microeconomic inspiration research directions, attributing limited significance to the interdependence between the micro-macro while ignoring the meso-level. This deficiency arises mostly through theoretical domains where the ineffective compartmentalization of conventional neoclassical optic continues and prevails (Barro, 1997; Galbraith, 1987; Ghazinoory et al., 2017; Mazzocchi, 2013; Vlados, 2019). Such conventional approaches, which ignore spatial dynamics in

their conceptual outline, can only perpetuate incidental and non-cohesive theoretical explanations, driving their interpretive frameworks to nothing more than simple additive instead of synthesizing rationale.

In contrast, in modern evolutionary economics, the spaces, firms, and industries intersecting them transversely and globally are co-evolving and dialectically correlated forces (Chatzinikolaou & Vlados, 2019; Hanusch & Pyka, 2007; Nelson et al., 2018; Vlados, 2020). In this context, widespread competitiveness measurements are also geared, which tend to attach paramount significance to the national dimension or, more recently, to the regions (Annoni & Dijkstra, 2019; Institute for Management Development, 2017; Schwab & Sala-i-Martín, 2017). In this methodological orientation and reflection, neither fragmented macro-competitiveness of space nor fragmented micro-competitiveness of firm exists. There are various competitiveness levels in organic interrelation, depending on the diverse types of firms or spaces influenced by the specific industrial and cross-industrial global systems and dynamics. Therefore, in this understanding (and in terms of global development), competitiveness includes evolving and dialectically connected elements between firms, spaces, and industries (see Figure 1).

The nation-centric understanding gives a fragmented conception of competitiveness for both the national space and the national firms. It is misleading to conceive competitiveness as a uni-dimensional

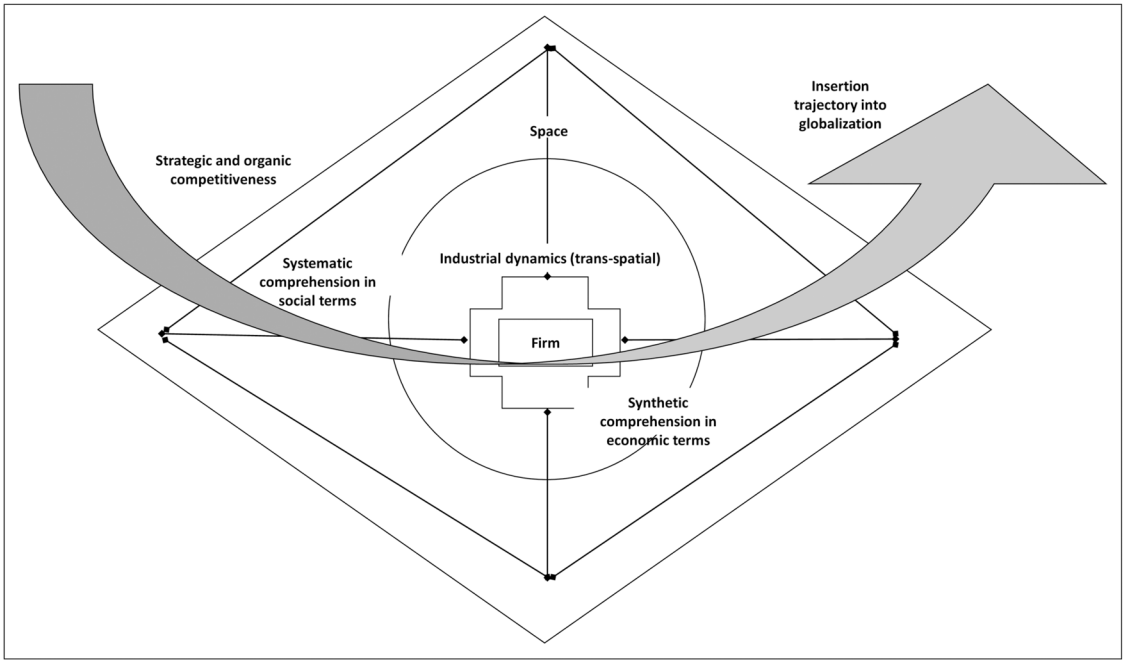
Figure 1. Competitiveness as a dialectical coupling between firms, spaces, and industries
Source: Adjusted from Vlados (2004)



phenomenon, allegedly only the outcome of the firm's action or space's structuration. In other words, no clear answer derives from such analysis to questions such as "Why do different firms within the same space have different competitiveness?" or "Why do different spaces in which the same firm operates have different competitiveness?" In the global understanding of competitiveness, where industries and the meso environment articulate cross-national, inter-national, and multi-national ties, competitiveness is multilevel, consisting of different spaces, firms, and industries. Thus, in this cognizance, competitiveness becomes "organic" because it is always conceived as a scalable entity, based on its systemic constituent parts' continual adjustment. Also, competitiveness is "strategic" because it is never an automatic and predefined dynamic but always occurs under the synthetic influence of actors' specific behaviors, which lead to the structuration and restructuration of the spaces-industries doublets hosting them, continually reproducing heterogeneity relationships at a "glocal" level (Evans et al., 2013; Roudometof, 2014). In terms of "glocalization," locality is not homogenized, as anti-globalizationists argue, but reproduces its evolutionary heterogeneity within an irreversible global system, which maintains its relative homeostasis until high levels of entropy force it into a mutation and essentially evolutionary metamorphosis (Argyres et al., 2012; Georgescu-Roegen, 1971; McEvily & Zaheer, 1999; Passet, 1979; Rodrik, 2011; Schumpeter, 1942).

Here, the new methodological horizon can only be always and simultaneously cross-firm, cross-spatial, and cross-industrial. This co-evolution between the different components that make up the global socio-economic system is the driving force behind the reproduction of heterogeneity (see Figure 2).

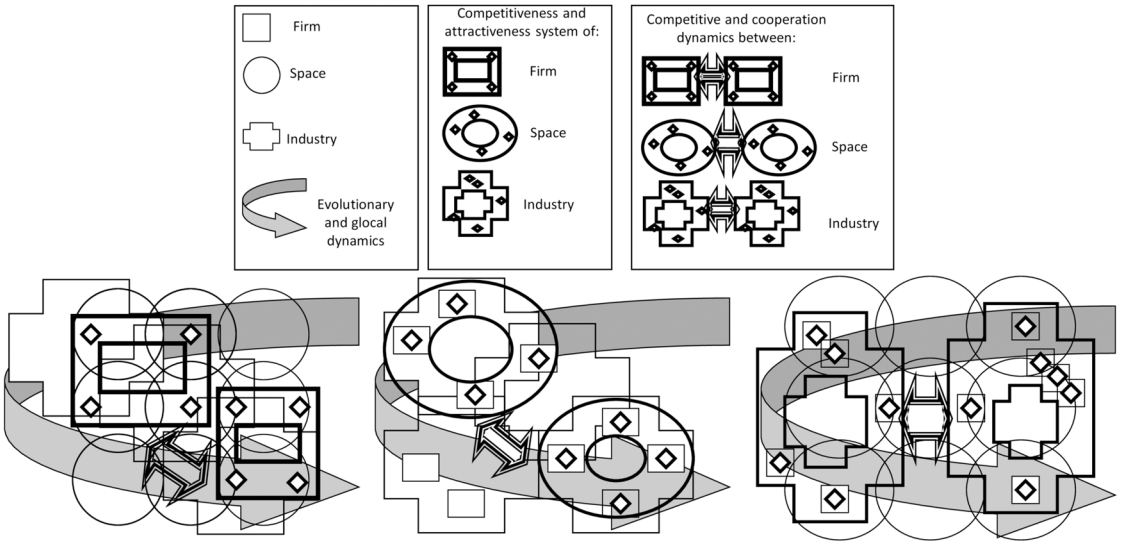
Figure 2. Reproduction of strategic and organic heterogeneity into the global process
Source: Adjusted from Vlados (2004)



In a global pattern of reproduction of strategic/organic competitiveness, all actors adapt and re-adapt dynamically and become gradually integrated (or do not become integrated, resulting in gradual deterioration and annihilation), co-structuring the trajectory of globalization. This dynamic adjustment and re-adjustment of spaces (social superstructure) and firms and industries (the economic base) is the reason for treating the global system as "unitary": because the actors, both individually and jointly, are the "structurers" of the global socio-economic system. In terms of dialectics, all constituents in today's complex world economy continuously reproduce theses, antitheses, syntheses and, as a result, the use of isolated and ahistorical analytical patterns is not only insufficient but, increasingly, erroneous and disorienting (Morabito et al., 2018; Sparke, 2018; Vlados et al., 2019). All this requires a transformation of the standard theoretical spectra relating to competitiveness, which are still dominant today. In simple terms, therefore, competitiveness is an indivisible theoretical entity, an organic, strategic, and dialectic concept which no orthodox theory of different specializations of economic science can fully address if it is exhausted and compartmentalized in just one of its dimensions (Hodgson, 2019; Slade-Caffarel, 2019). This is also the point at which nation branding theories fail.

Within this theoretical transformation that now seems necessary, the definition and application of a unified competitiveness framework acquire new content in contemporary globalization. The competitiveness/attractiveness diptych is a crucial theoretical transformation point in this gradual de-rigidification and explanatory re-adjustment. According to a relevant comment made by Michalet (1999), the competitiveness/attractiveness diptych functions as a catalyst for recalibrating the inter-national and multinational economy's workings. The contributions of the scholars of Paris X (CEREM[1], Nanterre) are fundamental in this repositioned context of competitiveness, which is essentially the other side of the same development coin with attractiveness. CEREM scholars also contributed considerably to the French School of Regulation. In the "École de la Régulation," it is argued that nationally oriented development

Figure 3. The different competitiveness and attractiveness systems of firms, spaces, and industries co-evolve, forming a unified whole
Source: Adjusted from Vlados (2004)



models derive from the progressive and evolving accumulation regimes in which the matching modes of regulations are developed (Boyer, 1986; Lipietz, 1986). According to Delapierre and Milelli (1995), the structuration of attractiveness on the part of nations (accumulation regimes and each regulation mode in the terminology of the regulation school) has now developed at a much higher level than offering simple incentives for foreign direct investment, utilizing marketing strategies to transform the territory's image as an investment site (or space) and to attract potential investor groups through direct contacts and communication.

On this point, it can be recognized that the two sides of this same reality can no longer be theoretically divided. On the one hand, the competitiveness of a space today must be mainly geared towards attracting the interest of the actors in globalization and, on the other, this attractiveness of space cannot be viable and sustainable if it is not based on a mechanism capable of structuring/restructuring the spatialized competitive advantages that it can effectively offer to these players (Dunning, 1992; Porter, 1990). More specifically, attractiveness is defined as the ability of a space to be a recipient of broadly perceived investment interest at all levels, be it local, regional, national, or global (Ivanov & Nugaev, 2017; Jáč & Vondráčková, 2017; Renczewska, 2012). The co-determination of competitiveness/attractiveness arises in terms of dialectics between firms, spaces, and industries, in three highly interconnected levels: the "seduction of nations" refers to how each national space attracts investment, the "seduction of industries" to how each industry attracts strategic interest, and the "seduction of firms" to how each business attracts resources (see Figure 3).

The integrated theoretical diptych of competitiveness and attractiveness can enhance our interpretive tools and understanding for how the nation can be conceived as a development interest space, far from only rigidly conceptualizing the macro-level. The spaces, firms, and industries are in a constant relationship of interdependence, and all these systems lead to the entire re-adjustment of the socio-economic plexus that hosts them through synchronous relationships of competition and cooperation (Brandenburger & Nalebuff, 1996; Carayannis et al., 2018). In the last section, a repositioned outline of conceiving the interest-receiving space is presented, capable of enriching how approaches to support the national space's attractiveness should be theoretically placed.

CONCLUSION: THE CONE OF ENTREPRENEURIAL AND INNOVATIONAL DYNAMICS AS A CONCEPTUAL FOUNDATION OF A REPOSITIONED CONCEPTION OF COMPETITIVENESS AND ATTRACTIVENESS

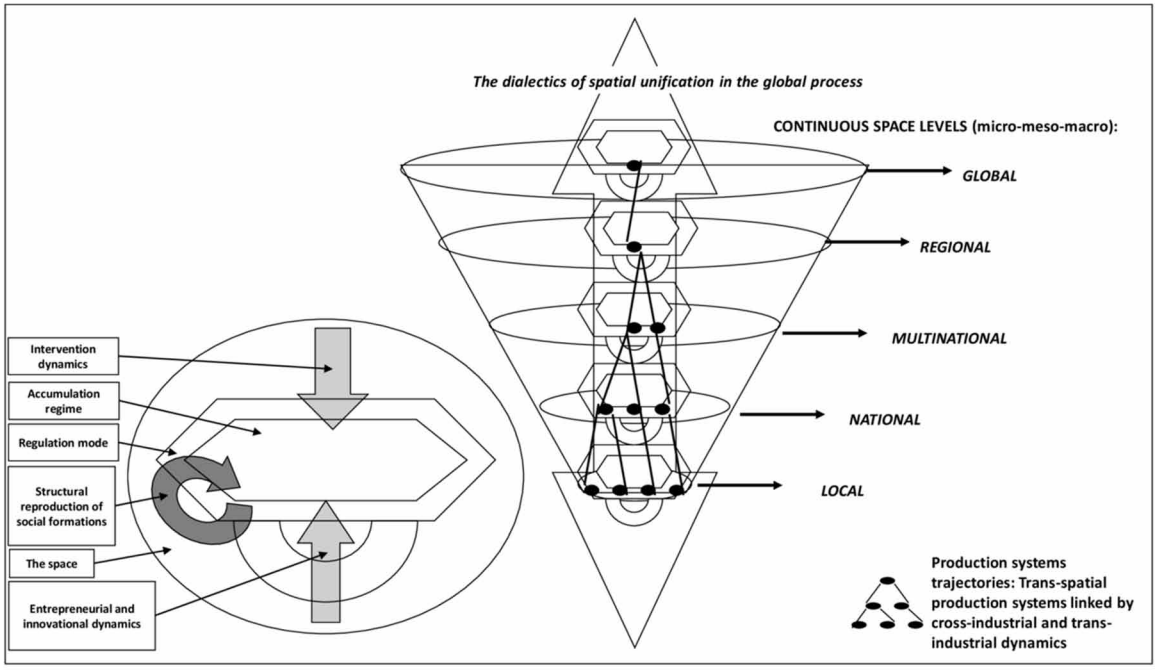
This chapter was structured as a proposal and counterproposal geared around the dimension of "saleable" national identity—what has been referred to as nation branding in the relevant literature for some twenty-five years—having as its primary motive the fact that the concept of competitiveness seemed to be relatively under-exploited within its workings and, consequently, the relative case of attractiveness as a dynamic whole. Presenting the conceptual evolution that is taking place within the literature of nation branding, we were faced with a multitude of contributions that, unsurprisingly, focused primarily on the nation's sphere, from a nation-centric perspective, that is, bypassing industrial and sub-industrial dimensions that unfold within globalization, structured and restructured by the firms' actions and dynamics of entrepreneurship and innovation.

In the introduction of this research, three questions were identified, functioning as the successive steps in building a new theoretical framework to put together the co-evolving dynamics of nation branding

and the diptych of competitiveness/attractiveness. This concluding section shows this new study path that unfolds in the field of nation branding, providing in a concise way concrete answers to the opening questions:

1. Regarding the first question, which concerned the "evolution" of nation branding's notion, the central research finding after studying the conceptual enrichment and the term's history concerns primarily the managerial and economic analysis principally oriented at the macro-nationcentric level. It is based on the science of marketing, with broad analytical avenues in geopolitics, diplomacy, cultural studies, and political economy in general. When it comes to the question of whether the study of the concept is of high importance, the increasing popularity of the term and practice of nation branding (most publications appear in the literature after 2010 even though it is an idea of the early 1990s) leads to interpretive enrichment and various case studies. We chose to exclude the latter from the analysis, even though they make up about 50% of the published texts, because this study is conceptual, oriented towards the suggestion of a new theoretical scheme.
2. In the direction of supplying an answer to why the study of competitiveness and attractiveness is lacking as a system for conceptualizing the way socio-economic organisms progress and develop their innovative potential, it seems that there is a fertile ground for enrichment strafed towards the design of economic policy solutions, bearing as an analytical axis the dimension of managing a nation's name, identity, and stereotypes. Competitiveness and attractiveness are demonstrated in the literature as a systemic, co-evolving, and organic diptych, which crosses transversely, receives

Figure 4. The cone of entrepreneurial and innovational dynamics: The continuum of space in the global process
Source: Adjusted from Vlados (2004)



flows from all spaces, industries, and firms, within an irreversible "glocalizing" process, in which the heterogeneity of the participant actors keeps being reproducible (Kindleberger, 1986; Lorenz, 2000; Vlados, Deniozos, Chatzinikolaou, et al., 2018).

3. In this perceptual context, the dimension of nation branding is inevitably subject to the forces of multilevel (micro-meso-macro) systemic competitiveness and attractiveness, which is not limited now to the superficial attraction of foreign investment. It concerns the "seduction" of potential investors (in the broad sense) and the overall and multilevel entrepreneurial and innovational dynamics (see Figure 4).

In this dialectic synthesis and integration that arises at all continuous spatial levels (local, national, multi-national, regional, global), all social configurations are reproduced structurally through cross-industrial (and trans-industrial) dynamics, articulated throughout the development spectrum of space. It starts from the micro, crossing the meso, and reaching the macro, from the smallest to the largest in the form of a "cone" that shows how the cogeneration trajectories of different socio-economic systems should be conceived. Simply put, the nation branding strategy, like marketing, is a subsection of an organization's overall strategy that seems increasingly nowadays to be multilevelly perceived, as is done for example in correlative and evolutionary SWOT analyses and corresponding evolutionary theorizing of the internal and external organizational environment (Hill & Westbrook, 1997; Porter, 1980; Vlados & Chatzinikolaou, 2019).

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

We would like to express our sincere gratitude to Dr. Andreas Andrikopoulos, who offered useful comments during this paper's writing.

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ADDITIONAL READING

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KEY TERMS AND DEFINITIONS

Attractiveness: The ability of a space to be a recipient of broadly perceived investment interest at all levels (local, regional, national, global).

Co-Opetition: The combined dynamics of cooperation and competition inherent in each organizational process as a dialectical product (thesis-synthesis-antithesis) at all spatial levels.

Competitiveness: The ability of an organization to perform better in broadly conceived innovational terms than other related organizations at all levels (local, regional, national, global).

Competitiveness/Attractiveness Diptych: The two sides of the same coin of overall socio-economic development dynamics for all organizations and at all levels (micro-meso-macro).

Evolutionary Economics: The heterodox framework for the study of multilevel socio-economic phenomena in the light of continuous mutation and metamorphosis, caused by the inherent dynamics of innovation and crisis within all socio-economic systems and organizations.

Glocalization: Understanding the globalizing phenomenon as subject to the constant evolution of locally established actors, who tend towards homogeneity while reproducing their heterogeneity.

Micro-Meso-Macro: The systemic, integrated, and indivisible conceptualization of space, in a way that is perceived in its evolution within social sciences.

Nation Branding: A nation's ability to create, communicate, and strategize a saleable cultural and merit-based background in international markets and relations.

Organic/Strategic Competitiveness: Strategic/organic competitiveness refers to a firm's ability to perform better than its counterparts, meaning that all entities are made up of constituents that continually adapt and re-adapt ("behave") to outperform their competitors and possibly increase in scale. It is observed through an evolutionary and biological-type perspective by taking into account the firm's co-evolution with the socio-economic spaces in which it operates.

ENDNOTE

[1] CEREM (Centre d'Etude et de Recherche sur l'Entreprise Multinationale): Center for Studies and Research on Multinational Enterprises.